



Ground to cover: It was a race to forget for India's leading sprinters, Animesh Kujur (second, left) and Gurindervir Singh (third, left). Kujur finished sixth in 10.32 seconds, while national record-holder Gurindervir had to settle for ninth in 10.39 seconds.

Murali Sreeshankar won the men's event at 8.07m, 31cm below his season best. The victory was useful; his June range remains the clearer guide for Japan. Aadarsh Ram Jothi Shankar won the men's high jump at 2.22m. Pooja took the 1500m in 4:17.24. Krishan Kumar's 1:47.69 left him 0.24 seconds behind South Africa's Molifi Mohlomi in the men's 800m event. Harmanjot Singh won the 5000m in 14:11.51, and Supriya won the women's high jump on countback at 1.75m.

An evening of difficult answers

Jyothi Yarraji did not finish the 100m and placed third in her specialist hurdles at 13.24. The time was 0.39

slower than her season best and 0.46 off her 12.78 national record. Japan's Yumi Tanaka beat her in 13.04, offering a glimpse of the opposition ahead. Charisma Taylor of The Bahamas won in 12.96 wearing a blue, thunderbolt-patterned kit called *'The Duke'*, her father's nickname and favourite colour.

She dedicated the win to him. "I'm happy with the win, but not very happy with the time," she said after her season's first outdoor race. "It was humid, but I'm from The Bahamas, so I'm used to these conditions."

South Africa's Tshepo Jason Tyantini won the men's 100m in 10.11, ahead of Oman's Ali Al Balushi (10.16) and Sri Lanka's Dineth Induwara Weeraratna (10.27). Animesh Kujur was sixth in 10.32. India's national record-holder Gurindervir Singh was ninth in 10.39, 0.30 off his 10.09 best. His best offers final potential; but this run would leave him vulnerable in the heats.

Gurindervir felt a slip soon after

the start and said the fear of falling disrupted his stride. "I consciously felt I might fall, and that's why I was left behind," he said. "Otherwise, there are no issues with my training. I'm looking forward to the Asian Games. That's my main target."

National 400m record-holder Vishal TK told *Sportstar* he did not start after suffering a groin injury in Saturday morning's training, opting not to aggravate it. His 44.98 makes him an Asian Games medal prospect. Botswana's Justice Oratile won in 45.35, while Manu T.S. placed fifth in 45.94.

Tajinderpal Singh Toor finished fourth in the shot put at 20.03m, behind Nigeria's Chukwuebuka Enekwechi (20.78m), Italy's Zane Weir (20.47m) and Karanveer Singh (20.06m). The effort was 1.74m short of Toor's national record, leaving him short of convincing medal form.

Annu Rani's third-place 56.96m was also well removed from her best championship form. Brazil's Jucilene Sales de Lima won at 59.13m, ahead